PORTFOLIO · HOUSING & DEVELOPMENT · 2026

Trinity Redistricting

and residential design studies



An independent, concept-stage housing proposal for the University of Vermont's Trinity Campus, and the floor plans, test fits, and development arithmetic I built to test it.

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Independent student work. Not an official UVM or City of Burlington plan, not endorsed by either, and not professional architecture, planning, or underwriting. Renderings are AI-assisted concept visualizations.

01 Project overview

Trinity Redistricting proposes replacing aging residence halls on UVM's Trinity Campus with a more complete residential district: first- and second-year halls (Trinity Peaks), upperclass apartments (Trinity Rise), a rebuilt Northside Dining, one walking and service spine with a garage (Trinity Way), and the preserved Cottages.

The ask is modest: a meeting and help scoping a Phase 0 feasibility study — not adoption of a design or a budget.

Trinity Peaks **1,450–1,600**	Trinity Rise **300–400**
Combined new beds **1,750–2,000**	Replaced (to verify) **≈565**
Net-new beds **≈1,185–1,435**	Illustrative capital range **$375M–$530M**

Figures: Trinity Redistricting Version 1.3, October 29, 2026 — authored assumptions and calculations, not measured outcomes or budgets.

02 My role

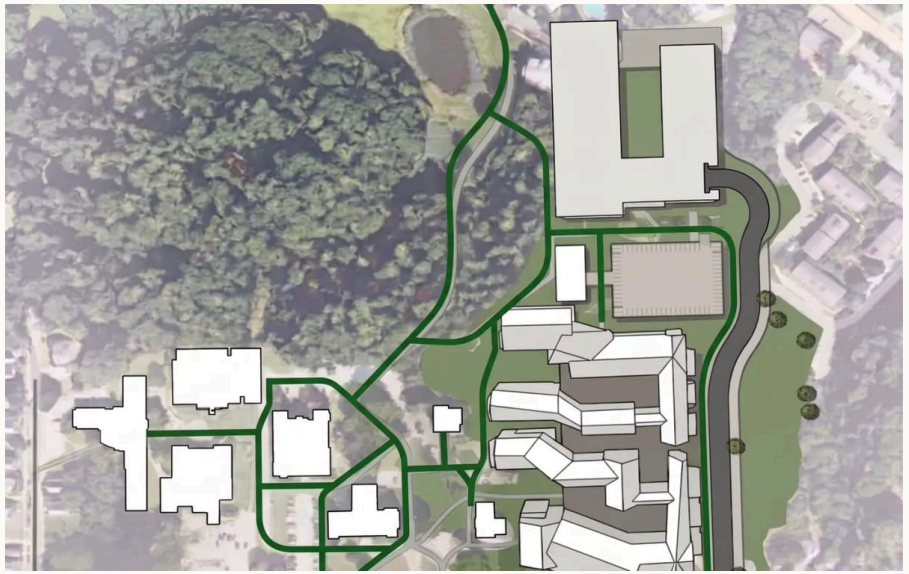
- **Originated the concept** and set its program and goals.
- **Researched** UVM and City records, zoning text, news, and cost benchmarks — 48 cited sources.
- **Authored** the bed accounting, capital study allowances, scenarios, and an evidence ledger that labels every figure.
- **Wrote and published** the proposal, memo, 16-slide deck, and an accessible document packet.
- **Directed** AI-assisted concept visualizations, and built the public site and Trinity AI with AI-assisted development.
- **Extended it** with original schematic plans, test fits, and a development model (Nov 2026).

What I did not do

No engineer, architect, planner, surveyor, or cost estimator has reviewed the work. I am a student exploring the field, not a licensed professional; drawings are schematic and dimensions are exploratory.

03 The site and the planning problem

- UVM proposed about 520 beds at Trinity in 2022; the City Council tabled the zoning change in February 2023.
- Adopted overlay, as reported: 40% coverage, 115-ft Colchester Avenue buffer, **55-ft absolute height ceiling**. The 2022 80-ft recommendation was not adopted.
- Halls to be replaced hold about 562–567 beds — from secondary listings that need UVM confirmation.
- Northside Dining sits inside McAuley, which the plan demolishes.
- Chittenden County rental vacancy: about 3.3% (June 2026).



Concept district map. Footprints are concept-stage, not surveyed.

04 Research: every number wears a label

Each figure in the proposal carries a status — documented, owner-confirmed, author assumption, calculated, scenario, or unresolved — and cites sources. Pages, PDFs, and Trinity AI are generated from one data file, and a build check fails if they disagree.

Three releases (May, Oct 28, Oct 29–30, 2026) each removed claims before adding features: an unsupported 15% rental-pressure claim was withdrawn, Rise was cut from 400–500 to 300–400 beds, and replaced beds were raised to ≈565 once demolitions were counted.

Figure	Value	Status
Trinity Peaks beds	1,450–1,600	assumption
Trinity Rise baseline beds	300–400	assumption
Existing beds replaced	about 565	calculated
Net-new beds (conditional)	about 1,185–1,435	calculated
Illustrative district capital study range	$375M–$530M	assumption

05 Early concepts and design direction



Trinity Peaks: wings read as no more than six floors. AI-assisted.



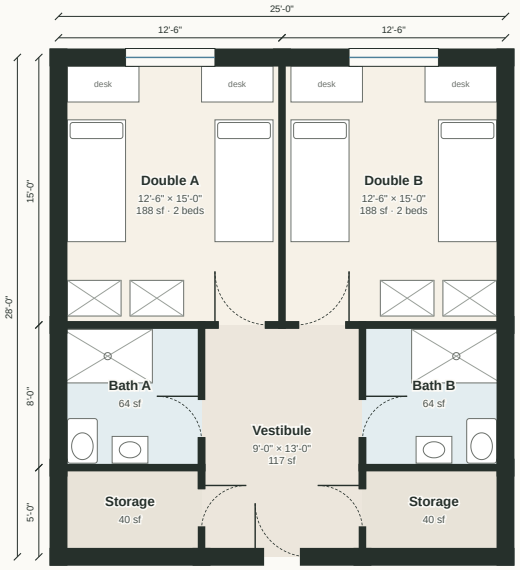
Trinity Rise, set deep in the site; height untested. AI-assisted.



Northside Dining rebuilt inside Peaks. AI-assisted.

Direction: calm, durable rooms over luxury; real common space close to bedrooms; residential wings as smaller neighbourhoods. The renderings set intent — the gap they left (no plans, no test fit) is what the next pages address.

06 Original floor plans: Trinity Peaks



Trinity Peaks · Four-person suite, Option A

Two doubles + two bathrooms off a shared vestibule

4 beds · envelope 25'-0" × 28'-0" = 700 sf · 175 sf per bed

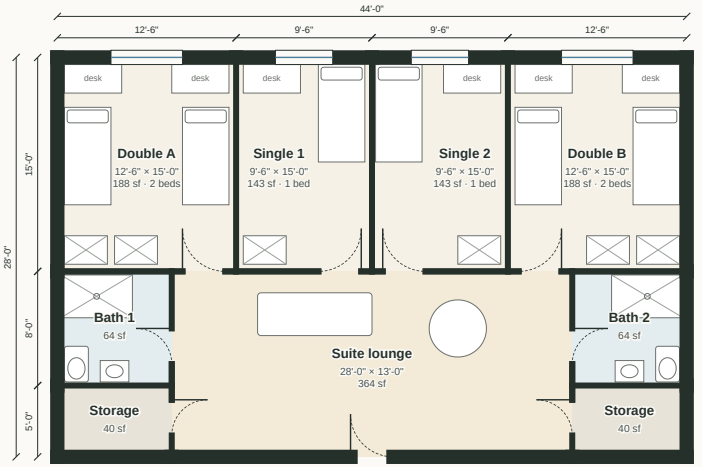
0 5 10 ft

graphic scale of assumed dimensions

SCHEMATIC EXPLORATION · v1 · 2026-11-06 · Dimensions are exploratory assumptions (studies/assumptions.json), not measurements.

Not code-reviewed, not an accessibility determination, not for construction. Orientation not established (no north arrow).

Independent student design study by Ivan Minier, drawn with AI assistance. Not a UVM design or an adopted part of the Trinity Redistricting proposal.



Trinity Peaks · Six-person suite

Two doubles + two singles + suite lounge, no triples

6 beds · envelope 44'-0" × 28'-0" = 1,232 sf · 205.3 sf per bed

0 5 10 ft

graphic scale of assumed dimensions

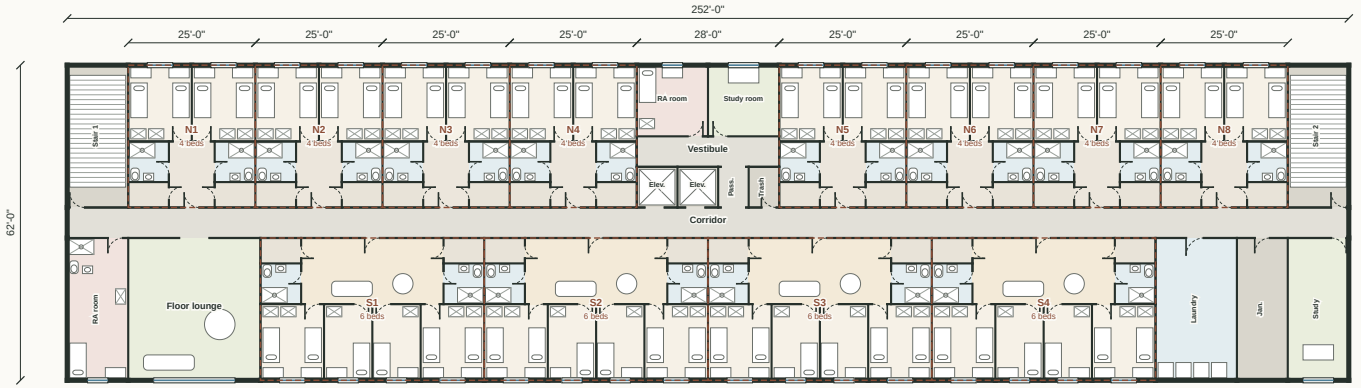
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Suites drawn from data and checked automatically for overlaps, access, door swings, and bed counts. Compared with suite-style halls such as UVM's University Heights (typology only), Option A is generous, which points to a compact next iteration.

07 A typical floor, and Trinity Rise apartments



Trinity Peaks · Typical residential floor, test fit A

Double-loaded bar: 8 four-person suites (north) + 4 six-person suites (south)

58 beds · envelope 252'-0" × 62'-0" = 15,624 sf · 269.4 sf per bed

0 25 50 ft

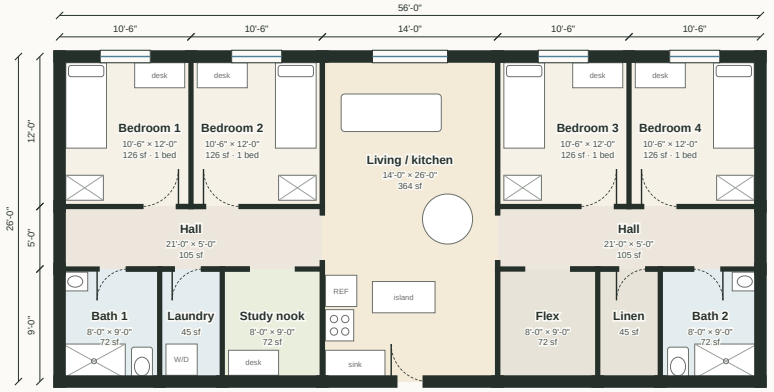
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Typical floor: 58 beds on a 252 × 62 ft floor plate (269.4 sf per bed), assembled from the suites so a change to a suite updates the floor.



Trinity Rise · Four-bedroom apartment, Option A

Four private bedrooms + two shared bathrooms

4 beds · envelope 56'-0" × 26'-0" = 1,456 sf · 364 sf per bed

0 5 10 ft

graphic scale of assumed dimensions

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08 Test fits and development assumptions

- **Peaks:** 1,450–1,600 beds at 5–6 residential floors ≈ 4.2–5.5 floor plates, roughly 74–84 ft tall — above 55 ft. Under 55 ft only ≈3 floors fit, doubling the footprint.
- **Rise:** 300–400 beds at 8–12 stories only with 8 units/floor × 12 stories or 10 units/floor × 10 stories.
- **Development model:** 300 beds; per-bed cost benchmark $233k (Virginia Tech 2026, not a Trinity estimate); financing, opex, and targets are illustrative and labelled.

Key result

At benchmark cost and full debt financing, debt service alone is ≈$16,790 per bed per year — more than UVM's 2026-27 University Heights suite-single rate ($12,090, nine-month room only). A project-level test, not UVM's system-level view: it shows why system financing, gifts, a partner, or lower cost matter.

09 Design alternatives and tradeoffs

Choice	Option	Gain	Cost
Peaks suite	Two doubles (A) vs four singles (B)	B: privacy for everyone	B: ≈52% more area per resident
Peaks suite	Six-person, no triples	Lounge doubles as circulation	3 residents per bath
Peaks height	5–6 floors vs ≤55 ft	Smaller footprint	Needs a zoning amendment
Rise bathrooms	2 shared vs 4 ensuite	Privacy, no scheduling	Loses study and flex rooms; ≈$153/bed/month per $25k premium (illustrative)
Laundry	Every floor vs fewer, larger rooms	Fewer rooms frees ≈448 sf/floor	Less convenient

10 Findings, and what I would investigate next

Findings

- Height is the hinge between capacity, cost, and approvals — it must be tested in feet.
- Replacement counts move net-new beds by hundreds; they need UVM's data.
- A public-benefit Rise at UVM-like rents is not self-financing under these assumptions.
- Premium features are modest per month, but must earn their place in resident value.

Next

- UVM headcounts, triple counts, and designed beds by building.
- A surveyed site plan and a planner's read of the overlay.
- Compact suite iteration, accessible units, and a unit mix for Rise.
- Surveyed comparable rents and professional cost input.

Sources and full documentation: trinityredistricting.com (proposal, documents, methods) · minier.us/work/trinity-redistricting · minier.us/studies (plans, test fits, model, assumption register). UVM rates: uvm.edu/housingdining/costs (observed Nov 6, 2026).